

Once in a palace far away, there were eight little Chinese Chimes. Their names were Doh, Ray, Mee, Fah, Soh, Lah, Tee and Hi-Doh. They lived happily together as part of Master Chi-Lu's Xylophone. Each afternoon the old master would sit and listen as the little chimes chimed out their beautiful melodies. Whenever they can, the little chimes play "Teow Wu Chuan" for their grand old master. "Teow Wu Chuan" is the circle dance. Even master Chi-Lu's visitors loved to sit with him on the floor-mats and listen to the eight little chimes.

As they grew older, the little chimes developed different personalities. They were different from each other, but they loved to play together and perform musical items for their grand old master. Little Hi-Doh began to notice that his sound was louder than all of the others. He began to stand out from the rest. He would sometimes ring out his chime loud and long. The others would try to stop him. They did not want him to get into trouble. But, he would not take any notice of his friends. When they tried to correct him, he would say, "I don't like you Lah! And you Ray, and you Soh! I don't need any of you to tell me what to do!" Everyone was sad to see little Hi-Doh becoming so proud.

One morning, as the sun was raising its head above the horizon, the little Chimes could hear Hi-Doh sounding out his brilliant tone. He had already hopped out of his pyjamas and was walking out the door. As they called to him little Hi-Doh shouted back, "I don't need you any more. I'm going to make it as a star, on my own!"

Now the others were really worried. They accepted that little Hi-Doh was different. They had nothing against his wanting to be successful in the world.

But they were sad to see how he had turned against his friends. He had become so proud and boastful. It was hard to feel sorry for him! So they let him go.

Hi-Doh decided that the best way to show off his talent was to put on a concert, featuring himself! So he hired a hall in town and advertised his concert. The wait was worthwhile. Soon the concert hall was packed with people looking forward to a new show in town.

Hi-Doh proudly walked out onto the stage as the announcer called his name. He began to ring out his beautiful chime. The audience started to applaud. Hi-Doh felt grand. At last he was a star!

Then the applause died down. But he kept ringing out his loud chime!

Suddenly, "Boo! What else can you do?" somebody shouted.

"Play something else!" shouted another.

What was happening?

Hi-Doh began to feel quite embarrassed.

"You're only a one-note-show," laughed the announcer.

With teary eyes he said to himself, "I wish my friends were here to ring out their chimes too."

Hi-Doh quietly backed off the stage as the audience began to throw tomatoes at him.

That very afternoon little Hi-Doh returned home to the palace. As he approached the courtyard, he could hear the pleasant sounds of many different chimes drifting on the afternoon breeze. It was all of his friends playing proudly together for their grand old master. Hi-Doh stood at a distance with a tear in his eye watching them play. He was longing to be accepted back as one of their friends. But he was afraid they would reject him.

Suddenly the music stopped. They had noticed Hi-Doh standing at a distance. At once, all of the little chimes went running over and threw their arms around little Hi-Doh. Of course they would accept him back. He was so happy. Master Chi-Lu gave a big smile of approval as they gathered back onto their positions and began to play.

Little Hi-Doh is still the loudest of them all. But now, whenever he gets excited and plays too loudly, he listens very carefully to his friends who try to quieten him down. Are you like that?

